Formal Proposal

Faculty Complaint and Suggestion Management App

A Digital Platform for Reporting, Assignment, Monitoring, and Resolution of Faculty Issues and Suggestions

Proposed for	Faculty of Management Studies and Commerce
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Document type	Formal Software Project Proposal
Date	25 May 2026

Version 1.0

1. Executive Summary

This proposal presents a digital application for the Faculty of Management Studies and Commerce to manage complaints, problems, and improvement suggestions submitted by students and lecturers. The proposed system will provide a structured channel for reporting issues with image or video evidence, classifying each submission as a complaint or suggestion, marking priority as urgent or normal, and assigning responsibility to the relevant authority for action.

The proposed app will support the full case lifecycle from submission to closure. After a case is submitted, an administrator will review it, assign it to the appropriate authority, monitor progress, and ensure that the informed user receives a message when the case is solved. The system will also provide dashboards showing attempted cases, not attempted cases, open cases, not-started cases, ageing reports, authority-wise progress, and priority-based summaries.

The app is recommended as a practical digital governance tool that improves transparency, accountability, responsiveness, and evidence-based decision-making within the faculty.

2. Background and Problem Statement

In a busy faculty environment, students and lecturers frequently observe issues related to classrooms, IT facilities, administration, safety, cleanliness, examination services, academic processes, infrastructure, and student support services. These issues are often communicated informally through verbal messages, phone calls, WhatsApp messages, emails, or personal visits to offices. Such methods are useful for immediate communication, but they do not provide a systematic mechanism for recording, assigning, tracking, and reporting actions taken.

The absence of a centralized system may result in duplicated complaints, delayed responses, unclear responsibility, loss of evidence, and difficulty in identifying repeated problems. It may also be difficult for faculty management to know how many issues are pending, which authority is responsible, how long a case has remained not started, and whether urgent matters are receiving timely attention.

Therefore, the faculty requires a simple, secure, mobile-friendly app that allows reporting users to submit complaints and suggestions and allows administrators to manage these submissions through a formal workflow.

3. Objectives of the Proposed App

- Provide students and lecturers with a convenient method to report complaints, problems, and improvement suggestions.
- Allow users to attach images and videos as supporting evidence.
- Enable classification of submissions as complaints or suggestions and marking of priority as urgent or normal.
- Provide administrators with tools to review cases and assign them to relevant authorities.
- Maintain an editable authority list that can be updated when responsibilities change.
- Notify the informed user when a case is solved.
- Provide dashboards and ageing reports for monitoring open, attempted, not attempted, and not-started cases.
- Support evidence-based decision-making and continuous improvement within the faculty.

4. Proposed Solution

The proposed solution is a web-based and mobile-friendly application named the FMSC Complaint and Suggestion Management App. The app will allow students and lecturers to submit complaints or suggestions using a simple form. Each case will include a title, description, case type, priority level, category, location, and optional image or video evidence.

After submission, the case will be available to authorized administrators. The administrator will review the case, confirm or adjust category and priority, and assign it to a relevant authority. The assigned authority will update the progress of the case, add comments, upload evidence of completion if needed, and mark the case as solved. The reporting user will then receive a notification that the case has been solved.

The system will provide a dashboard for administrators and management to monitor the number of cases, pending cases, urgent cases, not-started cases, ageing of not-started cases, and authority-wise progress.

5. Scope of the Project

5.1 In Scope

- User login and role-based access for students, lecturers, administrators, authorities, and management viewers.
- Complaint and suggestion submission with priority marking.
- Image and video upload with file size restrictions.
- Admin review, case assignment, reassignment, and rejection where necessary.
- Authority management: add, edit, activate, deactivate, or delete responsible authorities.
- Case progress updates, resolution notes, and closure.

- Notification to the informed user when a case is solved.
- Dashboard showing attempted, not attempted, open, not started, urgent, normal, solved, and closed cases.
- An aging report showing the number of days for not-started cases.
- Search, filtering, and management reports.

5.2 Out of Scope for the Initial Version

- Anonymous complaint handling, unless approved by faculty policy.
- Disciplinary inquiry management or legal case management.
- AI-based complaint classification.
- Public display of complaints or suggestions.
- Integration with external complaint management systems.

6. Stakeholders and User Roles

Stakeholder / Role	Main Responsibility
Student	Submit complaints or suggestions, upload evidence, view own cases, and receive resolution notifications.
Lecturer	Submit academic, administrative, infrastructure, or service-related complaints and suggestions.
Administrator	Review submitted cases, assign authorities, monitor progress, and manage case records.
Relevant Authority	Handle assigned cases, update progress, add comments, and mark cases as solved.
Faculty Management	View dashboards and reports for decision-making and service improvement.
System Administrator	Manage users, roles, categories, authority lists, technical settings, and backups.

7. Main Features

Feature Area	Description
Case submission	Students and lecturers submit complaints or suggestions with type, priority, category, location, description, and attachments.
Evidence upload	Users may upload images and videos to support the reported issue.
Admin review	Administrators read and verify submissions before assignment.
Authority assignment	Cases are assigned to relevant authorities such as maintenance, IT, department office, examination unit, or dean's office.
Progress tracking	Authorities update the status and add progress comments.
Resolution notification	The informed user receives a message when the case is solved.

Dashboard	Management can view attempted, not attempted, open, not started, urgent, normal, solved, and closed cases.
Age report	Not-started cases are displayed with age in number of days.
Reporting	Reports can be filtered by date, priority, category, authority, and status.

8. Proposed Case Lifecycle

The proposed system should follow a clear case lifecycle. This will help all users understand the present status of a complaint or suggestion.

1. Submitted: The user submits a complaint or suggestion.
2. Under Review: The administrator reads and verifies the case.
3. Not Started: The case is accepted but action has not yet started.
4. Assigned: The case is assigned to a relevant authority.
5. In Progress: The authority starts action and updates progress.
6. Waiting for Information: Further details are required from the user or another party.
7. Solved: The authority or administrator records that the issue has been solved.
8. Closed: The administrator closes the case after confirming completion.
9. Rejected: The administrator rejects invalid, duplicate, inappropriate, or out-of-scope submissions.
10. Reopened: The case is reopened if the resolution is not satisfactory.

9. Dashboard and Reporting Requirements

The dashboard is a major management feature of the proposed app. It should provide a clear and quick view of the current status of complaints and suggestions. The dashboard should support both operational monitoring and management decision-making.

Dashboard Indicator	Meaning
Total cases	All cases submitted during the selected period.
Attempted cases	Cases that have been reviewed, assigned, started, solved, or closed.
Not attempted cases	Cases submitted but not yet reviewed or acted upon.
Open cases	Cases that are not yet closed.
Not started cases	Cases accepted or assigned, but where action has not started.
Age in days	Number of days from submission date to the current date for open or not-started cases.
Urgent cases	Cases marked as urgent by the user or confirmed by the admin.
Authority-wise pending cases	Pending case load under each relevant authority.
Average resolution time	Average number of days taken to solve or close cases.

10. Proposed User Interface Wireframes

The following wireframes are low-fidelity interface mockups. They are intended to show the main screens and user flow. The final visual design may be refined during system development, but these screens describe the essential information and actions required by the proposed system.

Wireframe 1: Login Screen

FMSC Complaint & Suggestion Management App	
University Logo / Faculty Logo	
Email / Registration Number / Employee Email	
Password	
[Login]	[Forgot Password]
Help text: Use your university credentials to access the system.	

Figure 1. Login screen wireframe

Wireframe 2: Student / Lecturer Home Screen

FMSC Complaint & Suggestion Management App				
[Submit New Complaint / Suggestion]	[My Cases]	[Notifications]		
My Case Summary	Submitted: 08	In Progress: 02	Solved: 05	
Recent Cases				
Case No.	Title	Type	Priority	Status
FMSC-2026-001	Projector not working in Hall A	Complaint	Urgent	In Progress
FMSC-2026-002	Add more seating near the library	Suggestion	Normal	Submitted

Figure 2. Student/lecturer home screen wireframe

Wireframe 3: New Case Submission Form

Submit Complaint / Suggestion	
Case Type:	[Complaint] [Suggestion]
Priority:	[Urgent] [Normal]

Category:	Dropdown: Classroom / IT / Maintenance / Examination / Other
Location:	Building / Room / Office / Other location
Title:	Short title of the issue or suggestion
Description:	Detailed explanation of the complaint or suggestion
Attachments:	[Upload Image] [Upload Video]
Declaration:	I confirm that the information submitted is accurate to the best of my knowledge.
[Submit Case]	[Cancel]

Figure 3. New case submission form wireframe

Wireframe 4: Admin Dashboard

Admin Dashboard					
Total Cases	Attempted Cases	Not Attempted	Not Started	Urgent	
124	86	18	20	12	
Filters:	Date Range	Category	Authority	Priority	Status
Not Started Age Report					
Case No.	Title	Priority	Submitted Date	Age Days	
FMSC-2026-011	Broken chair in lecture hall	Normal	2026-05-19	6	
FMSC-2026-015	Water leak near corridor	Urgent	2026-05-22	3	

Figure 4. Admin dashboard wireframe

Wireframe 5: Admin Case Review and Assignment

Case Review: FMSC-2026-015		
Title	Water leak near corridor	
Submitted By	Student / Lecturer name	
Type	Complaint	
Priority	Urgent	
Description	Detailed case description appears here.	
Attachments	[View Image] [View Video]	
Admin Action	Status: Under Review / Not Started / Assigned / Rejected	

Assign To	Dropdown: Maintenance Division / IT Unit / Dean's Office / Department	
Internal Note	Admin note for authority	
[Assign Case]	[Reject Case]	[Save Changes]

Figure 5. Admin case review and assignment wireframe

Wireframe 6: Authority Work Queue

Authority Dashboard: Maintenance Division				
Assigned Cases	Urgent Cases	In Progress	Solved This Month	
22	04	09	13	
My Assigned Cases				
Case No.	Title	Priority	Age Days	Action
FMSC-2026-015	Water leak near corridor	Urgent	3	[Update]
FMSC-2026-011	Broken chair in lecture hall	Normal	6	[Update]

Figure 6. Authority work queue wireframe

Wireframe 7: Case Progress Update and Closure

Update Case Progress	
Case No.	FMSC-2026-015
Current Status	In Progress
Progress Comment	Action taken / current progress
Upload Evidence	[Upload Completion Image]
New Status	In Progress / Waiting for Information / Solved
Resolution Note	Required when marking as solved
[Save Progress]	[Mark as Solved]

Figure 7. Case progress update and closure wireframe

Wireframe 8: Management Dashboard

Management Dashboard				
Complaint vs Suggestion	Urgent vs Normal	Resolution Rate	Average Resolution Days	
Complaints: 78 / Suggestions: 46	Urgent: 12 / Normal: 112	72%	5.4 days	
Top Categories	Classroom Facilities | IT Systems | Maintenance | Examination			
Authority-wise Pending Cases				
Authority	Assigned	In Progress	Not Started	Average Age
Maintenance Division	18	08	05	6.2 days
IT Unit	14	06	03	4.1 days

Figure 8. Management dashboard wireframe

11. Functional Requirements Summary

Requirement Area	Key Requirements
User access	Login, role identification, user profile, and access permissions.
Case submission	Complaint/suggestion type, priority, category, location, description, image upload, video upload, and case number generation.
Admin handling	View cases, mark under review, change category or priority, assign authority, reject invalid cases, and reassign cases.
Authority handling	View assigned cases, update status, add comments, upload completion evidence, and mark as solved.
Notifications	New case notification, assignment notification, status update notification, solved message, and pending case reminders.
Dashboards	Case counts, ageing report, priority-wise summary, category-wise summary, authority-wise report, and date range filtering.
Audit trail	Maintain full history of submissions, assignments, status changes, comments, and closure.

12. Non-Functional Requirements Summary

Requirement Type	Requirement
Usability	The interface should be simple, mobile-friendly, and suitable for non-technical users.
Security	The system should use authenticated access, role-based permissions, secure file upload, and restricted attachment access.
Privacy	Users should only see their own cases unless they have authorized administrative or management privileges.
Reliability	The system should support regular backups, error handling, and data integrity controls.
Performance	Normal pages should load quickly, and file uploads should include validation and progress feedback.
Maintainability	Authorities, categories, and system settings should be configurable without code changes.
Scalability	The system should support growth in users, cases, and storage requirements.

13. Recommended Technology Approach

The app may be developed as a responsive web application. This approach will allow students and lecturers to use the system from computers and mobile phones without requiring a separate mobile app in the first phase.

Layer	Recommended Approach
Frontend	Responsive web interface suitable for desktop and mobile screens.
Backend	Secure server-side application with role-based access control.
Database	Relational database to store users, cases, authorities, comments, notifications, and audit records.
File storage	Controlled storage for images and videos with file size and file type validation.
Notifications	Email and in-app notifications in the first phase. SMS or WhatsApp may be considered later.
Hosting	University-controlled server or approved cloud environment, depending on policy and technical capacity.

14. Implementation Plan

Phase	Scope	Main Output
Phase 1: Analysis and Design	Confirm requirements, user roles, categories, authority list, workflows, and dashboard definitions.	Approved requirement specification and interface design.
Phase 2: Core Development	Develop login, case submission, image/video upload, admin review, authority assignment, and status tracking.	Working core system.
Phase 3: Dashboard and Notifications	Develop dashboards, ageing reports, solved notifications, and pending case reminders.	Management-ready monitoring system.
Phase 4: Testing and Pilot	Conduct testing with selected users, fix issues, and validate workflow.	Pilot-tested system.
Phase 5: Deployment and Training	Deploy the system, train administrators and authorities, and communicate usage guidelines.	Operational faculty app.
Phase 6: Enhancement	Add advanced features such as multilingual support, QR codes, escalation rules, or satisfaction ratings.	Improved version based on user feedback.

15. Risk Management

Risk	Possible Impact	Mitigation
Misuse or false complaints	Administrative burden and possible reputational issues.	Require login, maintain audit logs, and allow admins to reject invalid cases.
Sensitive information in attachments	Privacy concerns.	Provide acceptable-use guidelines and restrict access to attachments.

Delayed authority response	Pending cases are increasing, and user dissatisfaction is growing.	Use reminders, aging reports, and authority-wise dashboards.
Large video uploads	High storage usage and slow uploads.	Limit file size, format, and duration.
Unclear responsibility	Cases may be assigned incorrectly.	Maintain an updated authority list and allow reassignment.
Low user adoption	The system may not capture real issues.	Conduct awareness, provide simple instructions, and place QR codes at key locations.

16. Expected Benefits

- Improved communication between students, lecturers, administrators, and responsible authorities.
- Better documentation of complaints and suggestions with supporting evidence.
- Faster identification and assignment of urgent issues.
- Greater accountability through status tracking and audit history.
- Improved ability to monitor unresolved and not-started cases through ageing reports.
- Better decision-making through dashboards and reports.
- Support for quality assurance, service improvement, and stakeholder satisfaction.

17. Acceptance Criteria

11. Students and lecturers can submit complaints and suggestions successfully.
12. The system supports image and video upload within approved limits.
13. Every submitted case receives a unique case number.
14. Administrators can review, assign, reject, and reassign cases.
15. The authority list can be added, edited, deactivated, or deleted by authorized users.
16. Authorities can view assigned cases and update progress.
17. A case cannot be marked solved without a resolution note.
18. The informed user receives a message when the case is solved.
19. The dashboard shows attempted, not attempted, open, not started, urgent, normal, solved, and closed cases.
20. Not-started cases are displayed with age in number of days.
21. Role-based access control prevents unauthorized access to cases and attachments.
22. Reports can be filtered by date, category, priority, authority, and status.

18. Conclusion and Recommendation

The proposed FMSC Complaint and Suggestion Management App is a practical and necessary digital solution for improving communication, accountability, responsiveness, and service quality within the Faculty of Management Studies and Commerce. It provides a structured method for students and lecturers to report issues and suggestions, while giving administrators and management a clear mechanism to assign responsibility, monitor progress, and identify recurring problems.

It is recommended that the faculty proceed with a phased implementation, beginning with the minimum viable product covering case submission, evidence upload, admin review, authority assignment, progress tracking, solved notification, and the dashboard with ageing reports. Future enhancements can be introduced after pilot testing and feedback from users.

Appendix A: Preliminary Data Entities

Entity	Main Fields
User	User ID, name, email, role, user type, department/unit, contact number, active status.
Case	Case ID, case number, title, description, type, priority, category, location, submitted by, assigned authority, current status, dates.
Attachment	Attachment ID, case ID, file name, file type, file path, uploaded by, and uploaded date.
Authority	Authority ID, authority name, officer name, designation, email, phone, unit, and active status.
Comment / Progress Update	Comment ID, case ID, comment text, comment type, added by, and added date.
Notification	Notification ID, case ID, recipient, notification type, message, sent date, and read status.
Audit Log	Log ID, action type, user, date, old value, new value, related case.

Appendix B: Approval and Review

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Prepared by			
Reviewed by			
Approved by			